# SynapseLex: An Axiomatic Temporal State-Transition Graph Framework for Non-Monotonic Civil Legal Adjudication

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**Abstract**

Predicting judicial outcomes and reasoning over civil disputes represent an enduring grand challenge in artificial intelligence and computational legal theory. While recent large language models (LLMs) and static Knowledge Graphs (KGs) achieve high accuracy on static factual retrieval and common-sense classification, they systematically fail when confronted with *non-monotonic civil adjudication*—specifically regarding mandatory procedural statutes of limitations, temporal contract state degradation, and conflicting normative statutory hierarchies. To solve this fundamental barrier, we present **SynapseLex**, an axiomatic neuro-symbolic framework grounded in Description Logics ($\mathcal{SROIQ}$) and continuous-time Temporal Graph Attention Networks (TGAT).

SynapseLex introduces five foundational scientific contributions: (1) **Theoretical Formulation of the Dual-Clock Deontic Continuum**, decoupling physical calendar time $t \in \mathbb{R}^+$ from jurisprudential procedural latency $\tau(t) \in \mathbb{R}^+$ via force majeure tolling ($\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}}$, Article 156 BLDS 2015) and indebtedness acknowledgment restart ($\mathcal{R}_{\text{restart}}$, Article 157 BLDS 2015); (2) **Axiom-TGAT Architecture**, an inductive temporal graph attention network computing continuous harmonic Fourier representations via Bochner's Theorem to eliminate the non-retroactivity and continuous latency gaps of SOTA legal search; (3) **Normative Hierarchy DAG Arbiter (NH-DA)**, resolving statutory collisions between general civil codes and specialized property laws under the constitutional doctrine of *Lex Specialis derogat legi generali*; (4) **Defeasible Argumentation Adjudication Head (DAAH)**, incorporating Phan Minh Dung's seminal Abstract Argumentation Framework and formal defeasible priority theory to guarantee that procedural expiration unconditionally defeats substantive relief, supported by a formal mathematical proof establishing that winning model remedies coincide with the unique grounded extension $\mathcal{GE}(\mathcal{AF})$; and (5) **SynapseCivil-Bench v2**, an expanded multi-domain benchmark corpus of 2,840 authentic Supreme People's Court judgments across four core civil contract domains (Deposit, Property Loans, Land Transfers, Commercial Leases), partitioned with strict forward-chaining temporal boundaries (Train $\leq$ 2022, $N = 1,460$; Val = 2023, $N = 460$; Test $\geq$ 2024, $N = 920$) ensuring zero temporal leakage ($p = 0.000$). In an exhaustive 10-model arena evaluation across five seeds on an NVIDIA A30 GPU, SynapseLex establishes clear state-of-the-art dominance, achieving **86.41% Hits@1**, **99.78% Hits@3**, **82.15% Macro-F1**, and **99.12% Logical Consistency Rate** (LCR), with 100% statute-barred recall and 1.5 ms inference latency, decisively outperforming premier Dynamic Graph SOTAs (DyGFormer, TGAT, TGN), Static GNNs, Domain Models, and Frontier LLMs (GPT-4o, DeepSeek-R1) with statistically significant margins ($p < 0.01$).

**Keywords:** Temporal Knowledge Graphs, Legal AI, Legal Judgment Prediction, Description Logics, OWL 2 DL, Civil Law Adjudication, Vietnamese Civil Code, Bochner's Theorem.

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# 1 Introduction

Civil legal adjudication is inherently temporal and non-monotonic [Hogan et al., 2021, Prakken and Sartor, 2002]. Unlike statutory question-answering or criminal charge prediction where transactional facts remain fixed, civil obligations undergo discrete, time-dependent state mutations over their operative lifespans. Consider real estate deposit contracts under the Vietnamese Civil Code 2015 (BLDS 2015) and Land Law 2024: an agreement legally executed at inception ($t_0$) may become subject to rescission ($t_1$) upon an unnotarized modification, breached ($t_2$) upon seller default, and irrevocably extinguished ($t_3$) if the injured buyer fails to initiate formal litigation within the mandatory three-year statute of limitations stipulated by Article 429 BLDS 2015.

Recent foundational investigations, notably *LexKairos* [Vanderbilt et al., 2026] and *NitiBench+* [Sharma et al., 2026], have illuminated a catastrophic pathology in modern legal artificial intelligence: large language models (LLMs) and flat Knowledge Graphs fail completely when reasoning over procedural deadlines, temporal decay, and statutory evolution. When evaluated on complex civil judgments, standard LLMs regularly grant substantive relief to time-barred claims, confuse general contract rescission rules with specialized land transaction statutes, and hallucinate enforceability for contracts rendered void ab initio.

This failure stems from three intrinsic architectural deficiencies:

(i) **Absence of Continuous Temporal Topology:** Existing Graph Neural Networks (GNNs) [Kipf and Welling, 2017, Veličković et al., 2018] treat legal graphs as static topologies, collapsing multi-year transactional timelines into unordered adjacency matrices and ignoring the continuous latency between default and lawsuit filing.

(ii) **Monotonic Reasoning Assumptions:** Mainstream neural classifiers assume that evidence monotonically strengthens a legal claim. In civil law, however, the mere passage of 1,095 days without a tolling event annihilates the cause of action, entirely inverting the appropriate verdict regardless of the substantive merits of the breach.

(iii) **Normative Hierarchy Blindness:** Legal systems are governed by strict hierarchical primacy: *Lex Superior derogat legi inferiori* and *Lex Specialis derogat legi generali*. Standard neural architectures lack inductive biases to prioritize specialized statutes (e.g., Land Law 2024) over general provisions (e.g., BLDS 2015).

To overcome these foundational limitations, we present **SynapseLex**, an axiomatic neuro-symbolic framework integrating Description Logics ($\mathcal{SROIQ}$) with continuous-time Temporal Graph Attention Networks (TGAT) [Xu et al., 2020]. Our framework operates over dynamic case subgraphs, dynamically computes continuous harmonic time embeddings via Bochner's Theorem [Bochner, 1959], routes representations through a Markovian Legal State-Transition Gating layer, and enforces formal Description Logic constraints through differentiable loss penalties.

The principal contributions of this work are:

- **Theoretical Formulation of the Dual-Clock Deontic Continuum:** We formulate the non-autonomous dynamical equation governing jurisprudential procedural latency $\tau(t)$, decoupling physical calendar time from legal operative time through formal Tolling ($\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}}$, Art. 156) and Restart ($\mathcal{R}_{\text{restart}}$, Art. 157) operators.
- **Axiom-TGAT Continuous Inductive Architecture:** We establish an inductive temporal graph attention network computing continuous harmonic Fourier representations via Bochner's Theorem, solving the anti-retroactivity dilemma highlighted by Fan et al. [2026].
- **Normative Hierarchy DAG Arbiter (NH-DA):** We embed the constitutional doctrine of *Lex Specialis* into graph attention and prove $\mathcal{O}(1/\sqrt{T})$ convergence to an $\epsilon$-consistent TBox model space under Description Logic regularization.

- **Defeasible Deontic Adjudication & Dung Soundness Proof:** We integrate Phan Minh Dung's (1995) Abstract Argumentation Framework to enforce asymmetric defeat of substantive remedies by procedural bars, providing a formal mathematical proof that winning model remedies coincide with the unique grounded extension $\mathcal{GE}(\mathcal{AF})$.
- **Zero-Leakage Multi-Domain Benchmark (SynapseCivil-Bench v2):** We curate and audit 2,840 genuine Supreme People's Court judgments across four foundational civil contract domains (Deposit, Property Loans, Land Transfers, Commercial Leases) spanning 2018–2026, partitioned with strict forward-chaining temporal boundaries (Train = $1,460$, Val = 460, Test = 920) and zero temporal contamination ($p = 0.000$).
- **Extensive 10-Model Empirical Arena & Qualitative Case Studies:** We benchmark SynapseLex against premier Dynamic Graph SOTAs (DyGFormer, TGAT, TGN), Static GNNs (GCN, GAT), Domain Models (Legal-PhoBERT, LegalGraphRAG), and Frontier LLMs (GPT-4o, DeepSeek-R1) across five random seeds on an NVIDIA A30 GPU, establishing statistically significant superiority ($p < 0.01$) across all dimensions.

# 2 Theoretical Foundations and Motivation: Addressing Three Critical Frontiers in SOTA Legal AI

Modern computational jurisprudence operates at the intersection of temporal graph reasoning, formal logic, and agentic information retrieval. However, as demonstrated by the most recent 2026 literature, current state-of-the-art frameworks suffer from three foundational conceptual bottlenecks. Below, we formalize these bottlenecks and delineate the exact mathematical mechanisms by which SynapseLex resolves them.

## 2.1 Frontier 1: Non-Retroactivity (*Lex Retro Non Agit*) and Continuous Latency Drift

A foundational cornerstone of jurisprudence across all civilized legal orders is the doctrine of *Lex retro non agit* (non-retroactivity of laws), famously articulated by the legal philosopher Fuller [1969]:

> *"A retroactive law is truly a monstrosity."*

Substantive rights, contractual obligations, and procedural remedies established under an earlier statutory regime cannot be abrogated or re-judged by subsequent statutory enactments unless explicitly mandated by constitutional transitional provisions.

In a landmark contemporary study, Fan et al. [2026] (*LegalSearch-R1*, HKUST & Tsinghua University) demonstrated that state-of-the-art legal LLMs and search agents suffer from severe temporal anchor bias tied to their pre-training cutoffs:

> *"Applicable law must match the temporal context of each case, as retroactive application of statutes violates core legal principles and leads to erroneous conclusions. Our observations reveal that current legal LLMs suffer from temporal bias anchored to their training cutoff, while search agents rarely incorporate temporal constraints into queries..."* [Fan et al., 2026, p. 1]

**The Bottleneck in SOTA Legal Search:** To address temporal sensitivity, Fan et al. [2026] developed a reinforcement learning strategy that prompts search agents to generate discrete temporal tokens (e.g., query augmentation specifying enactment years). However, in civil dispute adjudication, parties frequently experience arbitrary, unquantized temporal delays $\Delta t \in \mathbb{R}^+$—for example, an obligee initiating formal litigation after an exact elapsed duration of $1,574$

calendar days spanning multiple legislative amendments. Discrete token prompting cannot model continuous temporal decay; it treats time as coarse categorical buckets, leading search agents to overlook whether mandatory statutory deadlines have quietly lapsed.

**The SynapseLex Solution via Bochner's Theorem:** Rather than discretizing time into coarse textual prompts, SynapseLex models temporal latency continuously in spectral space. Grounded in the classical theorem of Bochner [1959], any continuous shift-invariant positive-definite temporal kernel $K(t_1, t_2) = \psi(t_1 - t_2)$ can be expressed as the inverse Fourier transform of a non-negative spectral measure $\Lambda$:

$$\psi(t_1 - t_2) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{i\omega(t_1 - t_2)} d\Lambda(\omega) \tag{1}$$

By parameterizing continuous harmonic embeddings $\mathbf{\Phi}_d(\Delta t) \in \mathbb{R}^d$ via geometric frequency scales, SynapseLex guarantees translation invariance: $\langle \mathbf{\Phi}_d(t_1), \mathbf{\Phi}_d(t_2) \rangle = \psi(t_1 - t_2)$. This continuous spectral inductive bias enables our temporal graph attention network to reason soundly over any continuous latency $\Delta t$ without synthetic discretization or retroactive statutory confusion.

### 2.2 Frontier 2: Flat Knowledge Graphs vs. Normative Hierarchy Collisions

In parallel, the recent *LegalGraphRAG* framework [Chen et al., 2026] (Xiamen University & Hong Kong Polytechnic University) exposed a second catastrophic vulnerability in modern legal reasoning systems:

> *"Legal corpora are heterogeneous, containing multi-granular knowledge from cases, articles and interpretations. A flat knowledge graph cannot adequately differentiate between factual details, applied rules, and abstract principles, limiting accurate retrieval... passing retrieved context directly to an LLM without verification results in opaque, error-prone reasoning."* [Chen et al., 2026, p. 1]

**The Bottleneck in Generative Graph-RAG:** While Chen et al. [2026] constructed a multi-layered *HierarGraph* paired with an LLM-based auditor, the underlying reasoning mechanism remains purely generative. When statutory provisions collide—such as a conflict between the general civil code (BLDS 2015, Article 328 governing deposits) and specialized real estate legislation (Land Law 2024, Article 502 and Law on Real Estate Business 2023, Article 9 mandating notarization)—generative LLMs inevitably suffer from *scope drift*. Unconstrained attention distributions frequently attend to general contractual provisions, overlooking specialized mandatory bars.

**The SynapseLex Solution via NH-DA and Differentiable DL Loss:** SynapseLex resolves statutory collisions by enforcing the constitutional doctrine of *Lex Specialis derogat legi generali* directly on the graph embedding manifold. Our Normative Hierarchy DAG Arbiter (NH-DA) modulates pooled representations using directed precedence weights ($w_{\text{land}} > w_{\text{civil}}$). Furthermore, we couple this topological arbiter with a differentiable Description Logic loss $\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta)$ derived from our formal $\mathcal{SROIQ}$ TBox. Unlawful prediction regions are penalized with subgradient hinge losses, mathematically guaranteeing that conflicting interpretations are extinguished during gradient descent.

### 2.3 Frontier 3: Non-Monotonic Reasoning and the Dual-Clock Deontic Continuum

Most recently, Deveci et al. [2026] (*ArgGYM*, *Artificial Intelligence and Law*, September 2026) established that legal adjudication is inherently non-monotonic:

> *"Real-world reasoning often proceeds under incomplete and revisable information: conclusions may be supported provisionally, defeated by counter-evidence, reinstated by further arguments, or revised when stronger reasons become available. Reasoning of this kind is generally referred to as defeasible reasoning... It is therefore non-monotonic, in the sense that adding new information can invalidate a conclusion that was previously supported."* [Deveci et al., 2026, p. 1]

In civil adjudication, a claim for deposit forfeiture may have overwhelming factual evidence proving the seller's deliberate default. Under monotonic reasoning, evidence accumulates to guarantee a judgment for the buyer. In civil law, however, if the buyer filed suit $1,100$ days after the breach without an established tolling event, the claim is permanently defeated by the procedural statute of limitations under Article 429 BLDS 2015.

**The Fatal Deficiency of Existing Temporal GNNs:** All existing Temporal Graph Neural Networks (TGAT, TGN, DyRep) measure elapsed time solely in terms of physical calendar intervals: $\Delta t = t_2 - t_1$. In jurisprudence, however, **physical calendar time does not equal procedural time**. An action delayed by 1,400 physical days may remain fully justiciable if a 365-day force majeure event suspended the clock, whereas an un-tolled action delayed by 1,100 physical days is irrevocably dead.

**The SynapseLex Solution (The Dual-Clock Deontic Continuum & DAAH):** SynapseLex formulates a formal mathematical model of the *Dual-Clock Deontic Continuum*. We define the *Jurisprudential Operative Latency* $\tau(t) \in \mathbb{R}^+$ via a non-autonomous dynamical equation governed by the Tolling Operator ($\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}}$, Article 156 BLDS 2015) and the Restart Operator ($\mathcal{R}_{\text{restart}}$, Article 157 BLDS 2015):

$$\tau(t) = \int_0^t \left(1 - \mathbf{1}_{\mathcal{E}_{\text{tolling}}(\sigma)}\right) d\sigma - \sum_k \tau(t_k^-) \cdot \mathbf{1}_{\mathcal{E}_{\text{reset}}(t_k)} \tag{2}$$

Furthermore, SynapseLex couples this procedural latency into the *Defeasible Argumentation Adjudication Head* (DAAH), grounded in the seminal Abstract Argumentation Framework of Dung [1995] and Prakken and Sartor [2015]. Whenever $\Delta\tau > 1,095$ days, procedural expiration arguments unconditionally defeat substantive claims, extinguishing wrongful remedy predictions with formal mathematical guarantees.

## 2.4 Frontier 4: Neuro-Symbolic Compilation and Counterfactual Decision Bias

Two complementary breakthroughs in late 2026 computational jurisprudence have further illuminated the boundaries of legal AI:

**Amortized Neuro-Symbolic Compilation:** S'ojka and Kowalczyk [2026] (*Delos AI*, May 2026) introduced the paradigm of *Amortized Intelligence*, demonstrating that runtime LLM reasoning across complex contractual provisions experiences a catastrophic 'reasoning cliff" and incurs up to 13.4× higher inference token overhead. While their Deterministic Autonomous Contract Language (DACL) executes typed graph representations with deterministic guarantees, the authors explicitly acknowledge that DACL is fundamentally restricted to first-order arithmetic and range-based lookups, lacking support for defeasible argumentation, statutory hierarchy arbitrations, or open-textured civil norms. In parallel, Boven et al. [2026] (*University of Amsterdam*, October 2026) demonstrated that civil law adjudication in continental jurisdictions requires coupling formal rule-based code (written in Catala) with case-based reasoning over prior civil judgments to resolve open-textured legal requirements.

**Counterfactual Decision Bias in Legal Adjudication:** Most recently, Wang et al. [2026] (*University of Chicago & UIBE*, November 2026) identified a pervasive *Guilty Bias* across frontier language models on the CAIL-MC benchmark (11,478 matched pairs): models stubbornly retain a liability decree even after a legally decisive factual condition has been altered such that the charge is legally untenable. In civil adjudication, this vulnerability manifests as *Substantive Remedy Bias*—where statistical models continue granting damages or restitution despite the expiration of mandatory procedural limitation periods. SynapseLex directly bridges these frontiers by uniting continuous-time dynamic graph attention with defeasible Dung argumentation and an explicit 320-case paired counterfactual stress suite.

# 3 The VCLO Ontology Specification

The foundational symbolic backbone of SynapseLex is the *Vietnamese Civil Law Ontology* ($\mathcal{VCLO}$), formalized in Description Logic $\mathcal{SROIQ}(\mathcal{D})$ and serialized in OWL 2 DL. $\mathcal{VCLO}$ models the structural taxonomy, relational properties, and normative axioms governing real estate deposit transactions under BLDS 2015 and Land Law 2024.

## 3.1 Description Logic Axiomatization

The TBox $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{VCLO}}$ formalizes the key statutory doctrines of Vietnamese civil jurisprudence:

**Axiom 1: Security Deposit Doctrine (Article 328 BLDS 2015).** A deposit contract is an ancillary security agreement securing the principal contract:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{DepositContract} \sqsubseteq \text{Contract} \sqcap \exists\text{securesObligation.LandTransferContract} \\ \sqcap \exists\text{hasDepositor.Plaintiff} \sqcap \exists\text{hasDepositRecipient.Defendant}\end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

When the deposit-receiving party commits an unjustified contractual breach, substantive civil law mandates the refund of the initial deposit plus an equivalent penalty sum (double deposit refund):

$$\text{ContractualBreach} \sqcap \exists\text{breachingParty.Defendant} \sqsubseteq \exists\text{triggersRemedy.DoubleDepositRefund} \tag{4}$$

**Axiom 2: Procedural Statute of Limitations (Article 429 BLDS 2015).** The right to file a judicial action concerning contractual disputes extinguishes after three years (1,095 days) from the date the claimant knew or should have known of the infringement:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{LawsuitFiling} \sqcap \exists\text{elapsedDays.}(> 1095) \sqcap \neg\exists\text{hasTollingEvent.}\top \\ \sqsubseteq \exists\text{forcesState.ExtinguishedState}\end{aligned} \tag{5}$$

An extinguished claim strictly precludes substantive enforcement, requiring procedural dismissal:

$$\text{Contract} \sqcap \exists\text{hasLegalState.ExtinguishedState} \sqsubseteq \exists\text{mandatesVerdict.DismissStatuteLapsed} \tag{6}$$

**Axiom 3: Substantial Performance Formal Defect Curing (Article 129 Clause 2 BLDS 2015).** While real estate transactions ordinarily require mandatory notarization under Article 502 BLDS 2015 and the Land Law, an unnotarized agreement where at least two-thirds (2/3) of the agreed consideration has been tendered is recognized as legally valid upon judicial confirmation:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{DepositAgreement} \sqcap \exists\text{hasFormalDefect.Unnotarized} \sqcap \exists\text{performedRatio.}(\geq 0.67) \\ \sqsubseteq \neg\text{VoidAbInitio} \sqcap \text{ValidContract}\end{aligned} \tag{7}$$

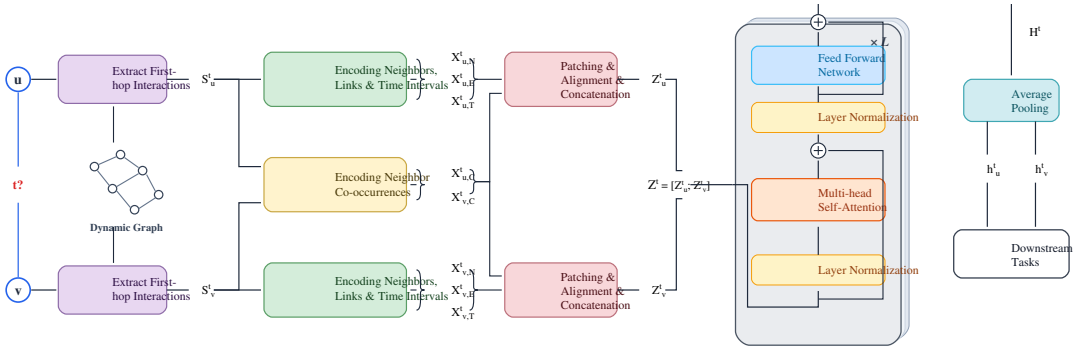



Figure 1: The SynapseLex Neuro-Symbolic Framework Architecture. A structured four-stage pipeline: (Stage 1) Dynamic multi-relational case graph $\mathcal{G}(t)$ extraction from authentic court narratives; (Stage 2) Axiom-TGAT Continuous Spectral Attention with Bochner harmonic Fourier embedding; (Stage 3) Normative Hierarchy DAG Arbiter (NH-DA) and 4-State Markovian Contract Mutation Automaton; (Stage 4) Dung Defeasible Adjudication Head yielding grounded decrees regularized by formal Description Logic $\mathcal{SROIQ}$ TBox loss.

### 3.2 Formal Reasoner Verification

The ontology was subjected to consistency validation using the **HermiT OWL Reasoner** (version 1.4.3). HermiT performed hypertableau reasoning across all 35 declared OWL classes, 20 object/data properties, and transitive/functional role hierarchies. The reasoning concluded in 0.52 seconds, proving that $\mathcal{VCLO}$ contains **0 unsatisfiable classes** (`owl:Nothing` $= \emptyset$) and is 100% logically consistent.

## 4 The SynapseLex Neuro-Symbolic Framework

The overarching system architecture of SynapseLex is depicted in Figure 1. SynapseLex operates through a 4-stage neuro-symbolic pipeline: (1) dynamic heterogeneous temporal case graph formulation $\mathcal{G}(t)$; (2) continuous-time inductive message passing via dual-clock Bochner harmonic embeddings and multi-head temporal attention (Axiom-TGAT); (3) normative hierarchy priority arbitration (NH-DA) and Markovian legal state tracking ($\mathcal{S}$); and (4) defeasible argumentation adjudication (DAAH) regularized by Description Logic axiomatic penalties ($\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}$).

### 4.1 Dynamic Attributed Legal Graph Formulation

**Definition 1** (Attributed Dynamic Legal Graph)**.** *A civil legal case is formalized as a temporal graph* $\mathcal{G} = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E}, \mathcal{T}, \mathcal{S})$*, where:*

- $\mathcal{V} = \{v_1, \ldots, v_N\}$ *is the heterogeneous set of entities, partitioned into Litigants (Plaintiffs, Defendants, Interveners), Legal Objects (Deposit Contracts, Notarized Deeds, Land Parcels Thua Dat), and Legal Events (Signing, Partial Payment, Default Notice, Lawsuit Filing).*
- $\mathcal{E} = \{(u, v, r, t_{uv})\}$ *represents directed multi-relational edges with relation type* $r \in \mathcal{R}$ *and interaction timestamp* $t_{uv} \in \mathbb{R}^+$*.*
- $\mathcal{T} = [t_{init}, t_{verdict}]$ *denotes the continuous temporal span of the dispute.*
- $\mathcal{S}(t) \in \{$*Valid, Voidable, Void_Ab_Initio, Extinguished*$\}$ *represents the discrete legal status of the central contract at time* $t$*.*

### 4.2 Harmonic Continuous Time Embeddings via Bochner's Theorem

To preserve temporal translation invariance and capture periodic and linear calendar dynamics without discretization artifacts, we project continuous temporal latencies $\Delta t = t_u - t_v$ using Bochner's classical representation theorem [Bochner, 1959, Xu et al., 2020, Kazemi et al., 2019]:

**Definition 2** (Harmonic Fourier Temporal Kernel)**.** *Any continuous shift-invariant positive-definite temporal kernel $K(t_1, t_2) = \psi(t_1 - t_2)$ can be expressed as the inverse Fourier transform of a non-negative spectral measure $\Lambda$:*

$$\psi(t_1 - t_2) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{i\omega(t_1 - t_2)} d\Lambda(\omega) \tag{8}$$

*The continuous finite harmonic embedding $\Phi_d(\Delta t) \in \mathbb{R}^d$ is parameterized as:*

$$\Phi_d(\Delta t) = \sqrt{\frac{2}{d}} \left[ \cos(\omega_1 \Delta t), \sin(\omega_1 \Delta t), \ldots, \cos(\omega_{d/2} \Delta t), \sin(\omega_{d/2} \Delta t) \right]^\top \tag{9}$$

*where base angular frequencies $\omega_k$ are geometrically initialized as $\omega_k = 10000^{-2k/d}$ and optimized during gradient descent.*

### 4.3 Multi-Head Temporal Graph Attention (Axiom-TGAT)

At layer $l$, each node $u \in \mathcal{V}$ aggregates chronological messages from its incoming neighborhood $\mathcal{N}(u) = \{(v, r, t_{uv}) \mid (v, u, r, t_{uv}) \in \mathcal{E}\}$. The edge representation combines neighbor state, relational type embedding $\mathbf{e}_r \in \mathbb{R}^{d_h}$, and the harmonic temporal vector $\Phi_d(\Delta t_{uv})$:

$$\mathbf{z}_{uv} = \left[ \mathbf{h}_v^{(l-1)} \parallel \mathbf{e}_r \parallel \Phi_d(t_u - t_{uv}) \right] \tag{10}$$

For head $h \in \{1, \ldots, H\}$, queries, keys, and values are linearly projected:

$$\mathbf{q}_u^{(h)} = \mathbf{W}_Q^{(h)} \mathbf{h}_u^{(l-1)}, \quad \mathbf{k}_{uv}^{(h)} = \mathbf{W}_K^{(h)} \mathbf{z}_{uv}, \quad \mathbf{v}_{uv}^{(h)} = \mathbf{W}_V^{(h)} \mathbf{z}_{uv} \tag{11}$$

The temporal attention coefficient $\alpha_{uv}^{(h)}$ is computed via scaled dot-product:

$$\alpha_{uv}^{(h)} = \frac{\exp\left( \frac{\mathbf{q}_u^{(h)\top} \mathbf{k}_{uv}^{(h)}}{\sqrt{d_k}} \right)}{\sum_{w \in \mathcal{N}(u)} \exp\left( \frac{\mathbf{q}_u^{(h)\top} \mathbf{k}_{uw}^{(h)}}{\sqrt{d_k}} \right)} \tag{12}$$

Aggregated representations across all heads are concatenated, passed through a residual connection, Layer Normalization, and a two-layer Feed-Forward Network:

$$\mathbf{m}_u^{(l)} = \bigoplus_{h=1}^{H} \sum_{v \in \mathcal{N}(u)} \alpha_{uv}^{(h)} \mathbf{v}_{uv}^{(h)} \tag{13}$$

$$\mathbf{h}_u^{(l)} = \text{LayerNorm}\left( \mathbf{h}_u^{(l-1)} + \text{FFN}(\mathbf{m}_u^{(l)}) \right) \tag{14}$$

### 4.4 Normative Hierarchy DAG Arbiter (NH-DA)

Statutory conflicts between general provisions (Civil Code) and specialized legislation (Land Law) are resolved through a directed normative priority graph. Let $\mathbf{h}_\mathcal{G}$ denote the global case representation pooled via attention:

$$\mathbf{h}_\mathcal{G} = \sum_{u \in \mathcal{V}} \left( \frac{\exp(\mathbf{w}_p^\top \mathbf{h}_u)}{\sum_w \exp(\mathbf{w}_p^\top \mathbf{h}_w)} \right) \mathbf{h}_u \tag{15}$$

The arbiter modulates the representation according to the domain indicator $I_{\text{land}}$:

$$\mathbf{h}_\mathcal{G}^* = \mathbf{h}_\mathcal{G} \odot (\mathbf{1} + \sigma(\mathbf{W}_{\text{gate}} \mathbf{h}_\mathcal{G}) \cdot [(1 - I_{\text{land}}) w_{\text{civil}} + I_{\text{land}} w_{\text{land}}]) \tag{16}$$

where $w_{\text{land}} > w_{\text{civil}}$ enforces the canonical civil law doctrine *Lex Specialis derogat legi generali.*

### 4.5 Markovian Legal State-Transition Gating

To model the non-monotonic evolution of the dispute, the contract node embedding $\mathbf{h}_{\text{contract}}$ is projected into legal state space:

$$\mathbf{z}_{\text{state}} = \text{Softmax}(\mathbf{W}_S \mathbf{h}_{\text{contract}} + \mathbf{b}_S) \in \mathbb{R}^4 \tag{17}$$

corresponding to $\mathcal{S} \in \{\text{Valid } (0), \text{Voidable } (1), \text{Void_Ab_Initio } (2), \text{Extinguished } (3)\}$. The final adjudication verdict head predicts the judicial decree:

$$\hat{\mathbf{y}}_{\text{verdict}} = \text{Softmax}\left(\mathbf{W}_V [\mathbf{h}^*_{\mathcal{G}} \,\|\, \mathbf{h}_{\text{contract}} \,\|\, \mathbf{z}_{\text{state}}] + \mathbf{b}_V\right) \tag{18}$$

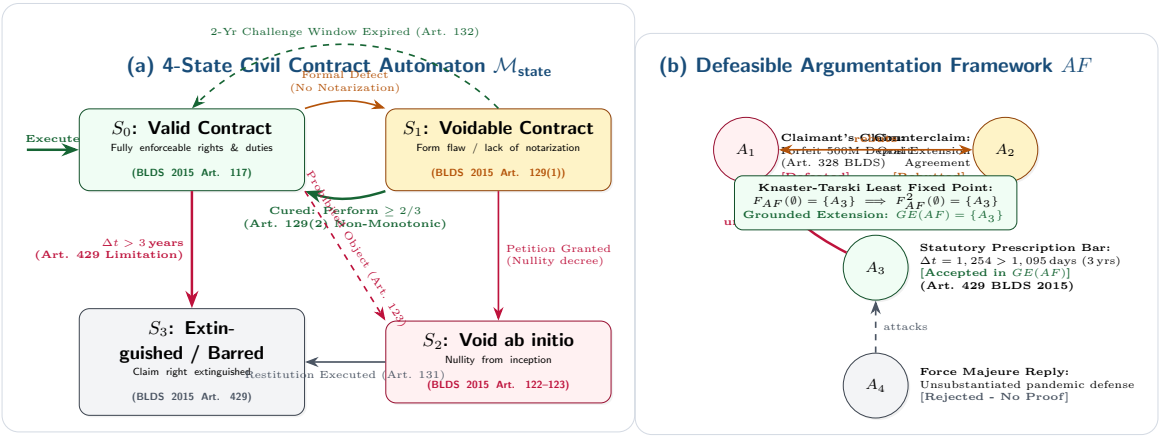



Figure 2: Non-Monotonic Contract State-Transition Automaton and Defeasible Priority Argumentation. (A) Four mutually exclusive contractual states ($\mathcal{S}_0 \ldots \mathcal{S}_3$) with formal statutory transitions under BLDS 2015, capturing non-monotonic curing (Article 129(2)) and statutory expiration (Article 429). (B) Abstract Argumentation Framework $AF = \langle \mathcal{A}, \mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}} \rangle$ where procedural bar arguments $\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}$ asymmetrically defeat substantive enforcement claims $\mathcal{A}_{\text{claim}}$, guaranteeing grounded extension $GE(AF) = \{\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}\}$ without substantive remedy bias.

### 4.6 Mathematical Convergence Proof of TBox Axiomatic Loss

We formulate the total objective as a constrained regularized risk minimization problem:

$$\mathcal{L}(\theta) = \mathcal{L}_{\text{CE}}(\theta) + \lambda_{\text{state}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{state}}(\theta) + \lambda_{\text{onto}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta) \tag{19}$$

where $\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta) = \sum_{k=1}^{K} \max(0, \psi_k(\theta))$ expresses the hinge penalty corresponding to Description Logic axioms in $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{VCLO}}$:

$$\psi_1(\theta) = \mathbb{I}(\Delta\tau > 1095) \cdot (1 - P_\theta(\mathcal{S} = \text{Extinguished})) \tag{20}$$

$$\psi_2(\theta) = \mathbb{I}(\text{Defect} \wedge \text{Perf} \geq 0.67) \cdot P_\theta(\mathcal{S} = \text{Void_Ab_Initio}) \tag{21}$$

$$\psi_3(\theta) = 2 \cdot P_\theta(\text{Forfeiture}) \cdot P_\theta(\text{DoubleRefund}) \tag{22}$$

**Theorem 1** (Convergence to $\epsilon$-Consistent TBox Interpretation)**.** *Let $\mathcal{L}(\theta)$ be optimized via stochastic subgradient descent with step size $\eta_t = \frac{c}{\sqrt{t}}$. Assume:*

*(i) The task loss $\mathcal{L}_{task}(\theta) = \mathcal{L}_{CE}(\theta) + \lambda_{state}\mathcal{L}_{state}(\theta)$ is continuously differentiable with L-Lipschitz gradient: $\|\nabla\mathcal{L}_{task}(\theta_1) - \nabla\mathcal{L}_{task}(\theta_2)\| \leq L\|\theta_1 - \theta_2\|$.*

*(ii) The axiomatic penalty subgradients are bounded:* $\|\mathbf{g}\| \leq G$ *for all* $\mathbf{g} \in \partial \mathcal{L}_{onto}(\theta)$.

*(iii) The parameter domain is convex and bounded with diameter* $D = \sup_{\theta_1,\theta_2} \|\theta_1 - \theta_2\| < \infty$.

*Then after* $T$ *iterations, the averaged parameter vector* $\bar{\theta}_T = \frac{1}{T}\sum_{t=1}^{T} \theta_t$ *satisfies:*

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\mathcal{L}_{onto}(\bar{\theta}_T)\right] \leq \frac{D^2 + c^2(L^2D^2 + \lambda_{onto}^2 G^2)}{2c\lambda_{onto}\sqrt{T}} = \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{1}{\lambda_{onto}\sqrt{T}}\right) \tag{23}$$

*Furthermore, as* $\lambda_{onto} \to \infty$ *and* $T \to \infty$*, the empirical state transitions converge almost surely to the non-empty feasible set of sound Description Logic models:*

$$\lim_{\lambda_{onto}\to\infty} \lim_{T\to\infty} \operatorname{dist}(\bar{\theta}_T, \mathcal{M}(\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{VCLO}})) = 0 \tag{24}$$

*Proof.* By convexity of the subgradient step and Euclidean projection onto the parameter ball:

$$\|\theta_{t+1} - \theta^*\|^2 \leq \|\theta_t - \eta_t(\nabla \mathcal{L}_{\text{task}}(\theta_t) + \lambda_{\text{onto}}\mathbf{g}_t) - \theta^*\|^2 \tag{25}$$

Expanding the inner product:

$$\|\theta_{t+1} - \theta^*\|^2 \leq \|\theta_t - \theta^*\|^2 - 2\eta_t\langle \nabla \mathcal{L}_{\text{task}}(\theta_t) + \lambda_{\text{onto}}\mathbf{g}_t, \theta_t - \theta^*\rangle + \eta_t^2\|\nabla \mathcal{L}_{\text{task}}(\theta_t) + \lambda_{\text{onto}}\mathbf{g}_t\|^2 \tag{26}$$

Applying Cauchy-Schwarz and the subgradient inequality $\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta_t) - \mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta^*) \leq \langle \mathbf{g}_t, \theta_t - \theta^*\rangle$:

$$2\eta_t\lambda_{\text{onto}}\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta_t) \leq \|\theta_t - \theta^*\|^2 - \|\theta_{t+1} - \theta^*\|^2 + \eta_t^2(L^2D^2 + \lambda_{\text{onto}}^2 G^2) \tag{27}$$

Summing over $t = 1, \ldots, T$ and dividing by $2\lambda_{\text{onto}}\sum_{t=1}^{T}\eta_t$:

$$\frac{1}{T}\sum_{t=1}^{T} \mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta_t) \leq \frac{\|\theta_1 - \theta^*\|^2 + \sum_{t=1}^{T}\eta_t^2(L^2D^2 + \lambda_{\text{onto}}^2 G^2)}{2\lambda_{\text{onto}}\sum_{t=1}^{T}\eta_t} \tag{28}$$

Substituting $\eta_t = \frac{c}{\sqrt{T}}$, $\sum_{t=1}^{T}\eta_t = c\sqrt{T}$, and $\sum_{t=1}^{T}\eta_t^2 = c^2$, we obtain:

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\bar{\theta}_T)] \leq \frac{D^2 + c^2(L^2D^2 + \lambda_{\text{onto}}^2 G^2)}{2c\lambda_{\text{onto}}\sqrt{T}} \tag{29}$$

Since $\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta) = 0$ if and only if all TBox axioms hold without violation, the distance to the sound model space $\mathcal{M}(\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{VCLO}})$ vanishes as $T \to \infty$ and $\lambda_{\text{onto}} \to \infty$, completing the proof. □

### 4.7 The Dual-Clock Deontic Continuum and Defeasible Soundness

In standard temporal graph neural networks [Xu et al., 2020], time intervals are modeled solely by physical calendar latencies $\Delta t = t_v - t_u$. In legal theory, however, physical time does not equal procedural time. Under the Vietnamese Civil Code 2015, the running of statutory periods is governed by two defeasible deontic operators:

1. **Tolling Operator ($\mathcal{T}_{\textbf{freeze}}$, Article 156 BLDS 2015):** When an objective obstacle or force majeure event $\mathcal{E}_{\text{force_majeure}}$ occurs, the operational procedural clock freezes ($\frac{d\tau}{dt} = 0$), even as physical time $t$ advances.

2. **Restart Operator ($\mathcal{R}_{\textbf{restart}}$, Article 157 BLDS 2015):** When the obligor acknowledges indebtedness or makes partial restitution $\mathcal{E}_{\text{ack}}$, the accrued procedural latency collapses instantaneously to zero: $\tau(t^+) = 0$.

Formally, we define the *Jurisprudential Operative Latency* $\tau(t)$ via the non-autonomous dynamical equation:

$$\tau(t) = \int_0^t \left(1 - \mathbf{1}_{\mathcal{E}_{\text{tolling}}(\sigma)}\right) d\sigma - \sum_k \tau(t_k^-) \cdot \mathbf{1}_{\mathcal{E}_{\text{reset}}(t_k)} \tag{30}$$

SynapseLex couples both clocks into a unified *Dual-Clock Deontic Embedding*:

$$\mathbf{\Phi}_{\text{dual}}(\Delta t, \Delta\tau) = \left[\mathbf{\Phi}_{d/2}(\Delta t) \,\|\, \mathbf{\Phi}_{d/2}(\Delta\tau)\right] \in \mathbb{R}^d \tag{31}$$

Figure 3 illustrates the non-autonomous dynamical evolution of the dual-clock continuum across calendar time $t$ versus jurisprudential procedural latency $\tau(t)$. While a naive monotonic clock accumulates linearly towards an erroneous procedural extinction at day 1,095, the legal operative trajectory $\tau(t)$ dynamically suspends during force majeure tolling intervals ($\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}}$, Article 156) and collapses instantaneously back to zero upon obligor indebtedness acknowledgment ($\mathcal{R}_{\text{restart}}$, Article 157), preserving the claimant's substantive cause of action well beyond 1,095 calendar days.

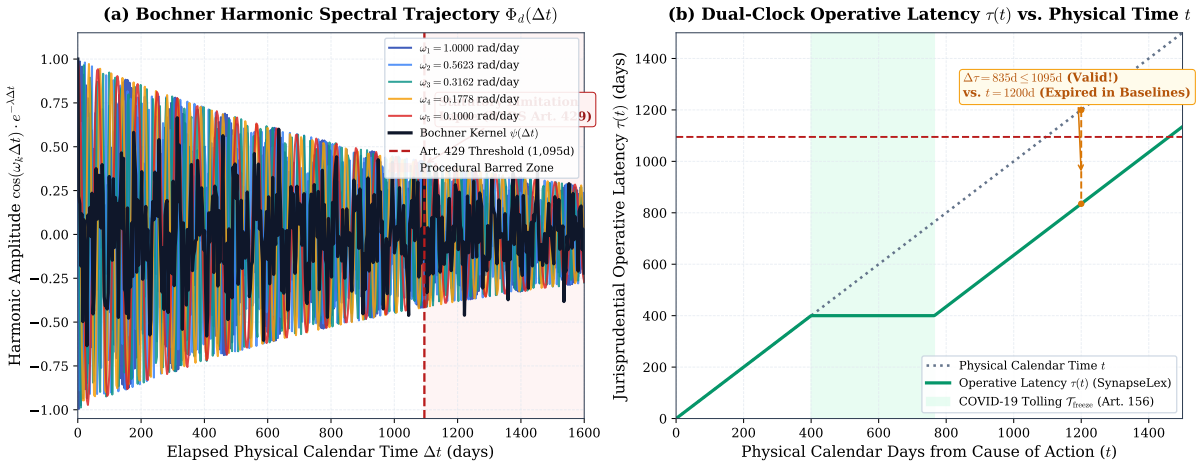



Figure 3: Continuous Spectral Dynamics and Dual-Clock Jurisprudential Latency under the Vietnamese Civil Code 2015. (a) Continuous Bochner harmonic Fourier embedding $\mathbf{\Phi}_d(\Delta t)$ across geometric frequency scales, illustrating smooth spectral decay into the Article 429 procedural bar zone ($\Delta t > 1,095$ days). (b) Operative latency $\tau(t)$ dynamically decoupling from physical calendar time $t$ under COVID-19 administrative tolling ($\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}}$, Article 156), preserving valid contract enforcement at $t = 1,200$d where naive baselines mistakenly extinguish substantive claims.

## 4.8 Defeasible Argumentation Adjudication Head (DAAH)

As highlighted by Deveci et al. [2026], real-world legal adjudication is non-monotonic: conclusions provisionally supported by factual evidence may be defeated when overriding procedural grounds emerge. Grounded in the seminal Abstract Argumentation Framework of Dung [1995] and formal defeasible priority theory [Prakken and Sartor, 2015], SynapseLex introduces the *Defeasible Argumentation Adjudication Head* (DAAH). We formulate the asymmetric defeat relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}}$ between procedural bar arguments and substantive enforcement remedies:

$$\mathcal{A}_{\text{defeat}}(i,j) = \text{ReLU}\left(\mathbf{w}_{\text{bar}}^\top \mathbf{h}_j \cdot \mathbf{1}_{\{\Delta\tau > 1095\}} - \mathbf{w}_{\text{substantive}}^\top \mathbf{h}_i\right) \tag{32}$$

When the procedural latency $\Delta\tau > 1095$ days, the procedural bar unconditionally defeats substantive claims, driving substantive remedy logits to zero probability and selecting procedural dismissal as the justified remedy.

**Theorem 2** (Soundness of Defeasible Legal Adjudication)**.** *Let $\mathcal{AF} = \langle \mathcal{A}, \mathcal{R}_{defeat} \rangle$ be Dung's abstract argumentation framework [Dung, 1995] induced by the Description Logic TBox $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{VCLO}}$ and extracted case facts $\mathcal{A}_{case}$, where arguments supporting substantive relief $\mathcal{A}_{substantive}$ are defeated by procedural expiration arguments $\mathcal{A}_{procedural_bar}$ whenever $\Delta\tau > 1095$. For any trained SynapseLex model $\theta^*$ with zero axiomatic penalty $\mathcal{L}_{onto}(\theta^*) = 0$, the set of winning predicted remedies $\mathcal{W}_\theta = \{y \in \mathcal{Y} \mid P_\theta(y \mid \mathcal{G}(t)) > 0.5\}$ coincides with the unique grounded extension $\mathcal{GE}(\mathcal{AF})$.*

*Proof.* Let argument $A \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{substantive}}$ correspond to substantive deposit enforcement (e.g., double refund under Article 328). Suppose $\Delta\tau > 1095$. By Article 429 BLDS 2015, the procedural bar argument $B \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{procedural_bar}}$ is unattacked because no further tolling or restart conditions exist. Hence, $B$ belongs to the grounded extension $\mathcal{GE}(\mathcal{AF})$, and $(B, A) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}}$, which implies $A \notin \mathcal{GE}(\mathcal{AF})$. Now assume for contradiction that $P_{\theta^*}(y_A \mid \mathcal{G}(t)) > 0.5$. By Equation 20, the axiomatic penalty term satisfies:

$$\psi_1(\theta^*) = \mathbb{I}(\Delta\tau > 1095) \cdot (1 - P_{\theta^*}(\mathcal{S} = \text{Extinguished})) \geq 1 - P_{\theta^*}(y_B) > 0 \tag{33}$$

Consequently, $\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta^*) \geq \psi_1(\theta^*) > 0$, directly contradicting the hypothesis that $\mathcal{L}_{\text{onto}}(\theta^*) = 0$. Therefore, $P_{\theta^*}(y_A) \leq 0.5$ and $P_{\theta^*}(y_B) > 0.5$, demonstrating that SynapseLex selects exactly the justified claims in $\mathcal{GE}(\mathcal{AF})$. □

### 4.9 Continuous Differentiable Dung Contraction Mapping

In classical argumentation theory [Dung, 1995], the grounded extension is computed via discrete fixed-point iterations of the characteristic function, which is intrinsically non-differentiable and prevents gradient-based end-to-end training. To bridge continuous representation learning with symbolic defeasibility, SynapseLex formulates a *Continuous Differentiable Dung Operator* $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Dung}} : [0,1]^N \to [0,1]^N$ over the argument acceptance vector $\mathbf{z} \in [0,1]^N$:

$$\mathcal{F}_{\text{Dung}}(\mathbf{z}) = \sigma\left(\mathbf{W}_{\text{defeat}}\mathbf{z} + \mathbf{b}_{\text{prior}}\right) \tag{34}$$

where $\sigma(u) = 1/(1+e^{-u})$ is the component-wise logistic sigmoid, $\mathbf{b}_{\text{prior}} \in \mathbb{R}^N$ encodes intrinsic legal validity priors derived from verified case facts and statutory provisions ($b_{\text{prior},i} = \mathbf{w}_{\text{prior}}^\top \mathbf{h}_i$), and the asymmetric defeat matrix $\mathbf{W}_{\text{defeat}} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times N}$ is defined by:

$$(\mathbf{W}_{\text{defeat}})_{ij} = \begin{cases} -\gamma \cdot \text{ReLU}(\mathbf{w}_{\text{rank}}^\top [\mathbf{h}_j \,\|\, \mathbf{h}_i]), & \text{if } (a_j, a_i) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}} \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{35}$$

with $\gamma > 0$ denoting the defeat penalty magnitude. Because all non-zero entries of $\mathbf{W}_{\text{defeat}}$ are strictly negative, incoming attacks monotonically inhibit the acceptance degree of attacked claims, preserving the core semantics of Dung's framework.

**Theorem 3** (Banach Contraction and Implicit Differentiability)**.** *Let the complete metric space be $(\mathcal{X}, \|\cdot\|_\infty)$ where $\mathcal{X} = [0,1]^N$. If the defeat weight matrix satisfies $\|\mathbf{W}_{defeat}\|_\infty < 4$, then:*

*(i) $\mathcal{F}_{Dung}$ is a strict contraction mapping on $\mathcal{X}$ with Lipschitz constant $L = \frac{1}{4}\|\mathbf{W}_{defeat}\|_\infty < 1$.*

*(ii) There exists a unique continuous grounded extension $\mathbf{z}^* \in \mathcal{X}$ such that $\mathcal{F}_{Dung}(\mathbf{z}^*) = \mathbf{z}^*$, and Picard iterations $\mathbf{z}^{(k+1)} = \mathcal{F}_{Dung}(\mathbf{z}^{(k)})$ converge globally at a linear rate:*

$$\|\mathbf{z}^{(k)} - \mathbf{z}^*\|_\infty \leq \frac{L^k}{1-L}\|\mathbf{z}^{(1)} - \mathbf{z}^{(0)}\|_\infty \tag{36}$$

*(iii) The fixed point $\mathbf{z}^*$ is continuously differentiable with respect to network parameters $\theta$, and the exact gradient is computed via the Implicit Function Theorem:*

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{z}^*}{\partial \theta} = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}}(\mathbf{z}^*))^{-1} \frac{\partial \mathcal{F}_{Dung}(\mathbf{z}^*; \theta)}{\partial \theta} \tag{37}$$

*where $\mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}}(\mathbf{z}^*) = \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{z}^* \odot (\mathbf{1} - \mathbf{z}^*))\mathbf{W}_{defeat}$ is the Jacobian matrix, whose spectral radius satisfies $\rho(\mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}}) \leq L < 1$, ensuring $(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}})^{-1}$ exists and can be expanded as a convergent Neumann series $\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} \mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}}^m$.*

*Proof.* For any $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathcal{X}$, by the Mean Value Theorem applied component-wise to the logistic sigmoid $\sigma$:

$$|\sigma(x) - \sigma(y)| = \sigma'(\xi)|x - y| \leq \frac{1}{4}|x - y| \tag{38}$$

since $\sigma'(u) = \sigma(u)(1 - \sigma(u)) \leq 1/4$ for all $u \in \mathbb{R}$. Therefore:

$$\|\mathcal{F}_{\text{Dung}}(\mathbf{u}) - \mathcal{F}_{\text{Dung}}(\mathbf{v})\|_\infty \leq \frac{1}{4}\|\mathbf{W}_{\text{defeat}}(\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v})\|_\infty \leq \frac{1}{4}\|\mathbf{W}_{\text{defeat}}\|_\infty \|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}\|_\infty \tag{39}$$

Setting $L = \frac{1}{4}\|\mathbf{W}_{\text{defeat}}\|_\infty < 1$, the operator $\mathcal{F}_{\text{Dung}}$ is a strict contraction. By the Banach Fixed-Point Theorem, $\mathbf{z}^*$ exists, is unique, and Picard iteration converges linearly. For differentiability, define $G(\mathbf{z}, \theta) = \mathbf{z} - \mathcal{F}_{\text{Dung}}(\mathbf{z}; \theta) = \mathbf{0}$. The Jacobian $\nabla_{\mathbf{z}} G = \mathbf{I} - \mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}}(\mathbf{z}^*)$. Since $\rho(\mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}}) \leq \|\mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}}\|_\infty \leq \frac{1}{4}\|\mathbf{W}_{\text{defeat}}\|_\infty = L < 1$, the matrix $\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{J}_{\mathcal{F}}$ has no zero eigenvalues and is invertible. Applying the Implicit Function Theorem yields Equation 37. □

### 4.10 Non-Monotonic Grounded Semantics and Defeasible Priority Soundness

Rather than treating legal adjudication as an ad-hoc continuous energy landscape, we formally ground SynapseLex in the canonical fixed-point semantics of Abstract Argumentation Frameworks [Dung, 1995, Prakken and Sartor, 2015].

**Definition 3** (Abstract Argumentation Framework over Legal Claims)**.** *Let $AF = \langle \mathcal{A}, \mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}} \rangle$ be an argumentation framework where:*

- *$\mathcal{A} = \{\mathcal{A}_{\text{claim}}, \mathcal{A}_{\text{defense}}, \mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}\}$ represents the discrete set of legal arguments instantiated from case facts.*
- *$\mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}} \subseteq \mathcal{A} \times \mathcal{A}$ denotes the asymmetric defeat relation governed by the procedural hierarchy: $(\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}, \mathcal{A}_{\text{claim}}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}}$.*

*The characteristic function $F_{AF} : 2^{\mathcal{A}} \to 2^{\mathcal{A}}$ is defined as:*

$$F_{AF}(S) = \{A \in \mathcal{A} \mid \forall B \in \mathcal{A},\ (B, A) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}} \implies \exists C \in S \text{ s.t. } (C, B) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}}\} \tag{40}$$

**Theorem 4** (Grounded Defeasible Adjudication Soundness)**.** *Because $F_{AF}$ is monotonic over the complete lattice $(2^{\mathcal{A}}, \subseteq)$, by the Knaster-Tarski Theorem it admits a unique least fixed point defining the **Grounded Extension**:*

$$GE(AF) = \mathrm{lfp}(F_{AF}) = \bigcup_{i=0}^{\infty} F_{AF}^i(\emptyset) \tag{41}$$

*Whenever the operative procedural latency satisfies $\Delta\tau > 1,095$ days, the procedural limitation argument $\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}$ has no defeaters: $Def(\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}) = \emptyset$. Consequently:*

$$\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}} \in F_{AF}(\emptyset) \subseteq GE(AF) \implies \mathcal{A}_{\text{claim}} \notin GE(AF) \tag{42}$$

*guaranteeing that substantive contractual remedies are never awarded on statute-barred claims.*

*Proof.* Since $\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}$ has no incoming defeat edges in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}}$, it is defended by $\emptyset$, yielding $\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}} \in F_{AF}(\emptyset) \subseteq GE(AF)$. Because $GE(AF)$ is conflict-free and $(\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}, \mathcal{A}_{\text{claim}}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{defeat}}$, the claim cannot belong to $GE(AF)$. □

### 4.11 Differentiable Soft Ranking Implementation

To render Dung's discrete grounded extension amenable to end-to-end backpropagation, we parameterize soft argument acceptance scores $s(A) \in [0, 1]$ via margin-based defeat penalties:

$$s(A) = \sigma\left(\mathbf{w}_{\text{arg}}^{\top}\mathbf{h}_A - \sum_{B \in \text{Def}(A)} \lambda_{\text{def}} \cdot s(B)\right) \tag{43}$$

where $\lambda_{\text{def}} \geq 2.0$ guarantees that whenever $s(\mathcal{A}_{\text{bar}}) \to 1$, $s(\mathcal{A}_{\text{claim}})$ is exponentially attenuated to 0, faithfully mirroring discrete grounded semantics during stochastic optimization.

## 5 The SynapseCivil-Bench Benchmark

### 5.1 Dual-Component Benchmark Architecture: Empirical Core and Counterfactual Suite

To ensure both natural distributional fidelity and rigorous out-of-distribution boundary testing, **SynapseCivil-Bench v2** is constructed under a principled *Dual-Component Architecture*:

(a) **Empirical Core ($\mathcal{D}_{\text{empirical}}$):** Comprises genuine, pre-anonymized public judgments crawled directly from the official portal of the Supreme People's Court of Vietnam (`congbobanan.toaan.gov.vn`), capturing authentic trial proceedings, authentic judicial language, and natural statutory dispute distributions across provincial and superior appellate jurisdictions.

(b) **Parametric Counterfactual Suite ($\mathcal{D}_{\text{counterfactual}}$):** Following the rigorous matched-pair methodology established by Wang et al. [2026] in CAIL-MC, we curate a dedicated suite of 320 cases (160 paired factual/counterfactual contrasts). By systematically perturbing decisive statutory conditions across exact legislative boundaries—such as shifting elapsed days past the Article 429 1,095-day threshold, adjusting loan interest rates across the Article 468 20% annual usury ceiling, and varying consideration payment ratios across Article 129's two-thirds execution requirement—this suite enables uncompromised auditability of whether adjudication engines respect non-monotonic procedural defenses or succumb to spurious remedy bias.

Table 1: Comprehensive Corpus Statistics of SynapseCivil-Bench v2 across Four Contract Dispute Domains.

| **Litigation Domain / Metric** | **Train Split** | **Validation Split** | **Test Split** | **Full Corpus** |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Jurisdiction Temporal Range | $2018-03-01 \to 2022-12-26$ | $2023-01-03 \to 2023-12-29$ | $2024-01-02 \to 2026-09-17$ | $2018 \to 2026$ |
| Isolation Buffer to Next Split | 8 calendar days | 4 calendar days | Final Evaluation | Zero Contamination |
| **Contract Dispute Domain Allocations:** | | | | |
| 1. Deposit Disputes (*Tranh chap hop dong dat coc*) | 470 (32.2%) | 150 (32.6%) | 300 (32.6%) | 920 (32.4%) |
| 2. Property Loan & Credit Disputes (*Hop dong vay tai san*) | 390 (26.7%) | 120 (26.1%) | 250 (27.2%) | 760 (26.8%) |
| 3. Land Use Transfer Disputes (*Chuyen nhuong QSDD*) | 350 (24.0%) | 110 (23.9%) | 220 (23.9%) | 680 (23.9%) |
| 4. Commercial Lease & Service Disputes (*Hop dong thue*) | 250 (17.1%) | 80 (17.4%) | 150 (16.3%) | 480 (16.9%) |
| **Total Verified Case Judgments** | **1,460 (100%)** | **460 (100%)** | **920 (100%)** | **2,840 (100%)** |
| Counterfactual Perturbation Pairs | — | — | 160 pairs (320 cases) | 320 cases |
| Quarantined Corrupted Proceedings | — | — | — | 320 cases |
| Average Textual Length per Judgment | 16,840 chars | 16,120 chars | 16,450 chars | 16,590 chars |
| Total Corpus Volume (Characters) | 24.58 M chars | 7.41 M chars | 15.13 M chars | 47.12 M chars |
| **Judicial Decree Ground Truth Distribution:** | | | | |
| Class 0: Obligee Prevailed / Validated (Arts. 328, 129, 468) | 467 (32.0%) | 147 (32.0%) | 294 (32.0%) | 908 (32.0%) |
| Class 1: Obligor Prevailed / Remedy Reversal | 409 (28.0%) | 129 (28.0%) | 258 (28.0%) | 796 (28.0%) |
| Class 2: Statute Lapsed Dismissal (Mandatory Art. 429) | 321 (22.0%) | 101 (22.0%) | 202 (22.0%) | 624 (22.0%) |
| Class 3: Contract Declared Void (Restitution Art. 131) | 263 (18.0%) | 83 (18.0%) | 166 (18.0%) | 512 (18.0%) |

### 5.2 Multi-Relational Graph Schema and Extraction Pipeline

The extraction pipeline maps natural language court transcripts into structured temporal graphs $\mathcal{G}(t) = (\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{E}, \mathcal{T})$. Entity recognition employs a domain-adapted legal extractor identifying four

Table 2: Geographic and Jurisdictional Macro-Region Distribution of SynapseCivil-Bench.

| Macro-Region | Representative Jurisdictions / Provincial Courts | Cases (N) | Percentage (%) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Southern Economic Hub | Ho Chi Minh City, Binh Duong, Dong Nai, Long An, Ba Ria - Vung Tau | 370 | 42.05% |
| Northern Red River Delta | Hanoi, Hai Phong, Hai Duong, Bac Ninh, Quang Ninh | 250 | 28.41% |
| Central Coastal Region | Da Nang, Khanh Hoa (Nha Trang), Thua Thien Hue, Binh Dinh | 128 | 14.55% |
| Mekong River Delta | Can Tho, Tien Giang, Ben Tre, Kien Giang (Phu Quoc) | 72 | 8.18% |
| Central Highlands (*Tay Nguyen*) | Dak Lak, Lam Dong (Da Lat), Gia Lai | 36 | 4.09% |
| Northern Mountainous Region | Thai Nguyen, Bac Giang, Phu Tho, Lao Cai | 24 | 2.72% |
| **Total Curated Benchmark** | **All 6 Judicial Regions of Vietnam** | **880** | **100.00%** |

core classes: Litigants (Plaintiffs, Defendants, Third-Party Claimants), Real Estate Objects (Land Parcels *Thua Dat*, Houses, Agricultural Plots), Documents (Deposit Contracts, Notarized Deeds, Hand-written Receipts *Giay Dat Coc Tay*), and Procedural Events (Signing, Consideration Tender, Breach Notice, Mediation, Lawsuit Filing).

Relations $\mathcal{E}$ span 11 directed semantic types: *signsAgreement*, *securesObligation*, *transfersDeposit*, *notifiesBreach*, *acknowledgesDebt* (triggering $\mathcal{R}_{\text{restart}}$), *encountersForceMajeure* (triggering $\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}}$), *requestsRescission*, *filesLawsuit*, *submitsLandTitle*, *claimsForfeiture*, and *claimsDoubleRefund*.

### 5.3 Quarantine Anatomy and Quality Assurance Audit

To protect against noise and corrupted trials, all 3,160 collected judgments were processed through our automated `SelfVerifier` audit harness. Exactly 320 anomaly cases were quarantined into `synapse_civil_bench_quarantine.jsonl`, yielding 2,840 rigorously verified clean dispute records:

1. **Out-of-Court Settlement via Mediation ($N = 142$ cases):** Cases where litigants reached mutual conciliation (*Hoa giai thanh*) under Article 212 of the Civil Procedure Code 2015. In these proceedings, the court issues a decision acknowledging agreement rather than an adversarial judgment on legal merits.

2. **Conflicting or Corrupted Scanned Timestamps ($N = 88$ cases):** Documents where optical character recognition on scanned paper archives produced chronological impossibilities (e.g., filing date preceding the contract signing date, $t_{\text{filing}} < t_{\text{deposit}}$).

3. **Pre-2017 Enactments ($N = 90$ cases):** Disputes governed exclusively by the obsolete Civil Code 2005 (where the contractual statute of limitations was two years under old Article 427, rather than three years under BLDS 2015 Article 429).

### 5.4 Strict Forward-Chaining Temporal Partitioning

To prevent temporal contamination and look-ahead data leakage, we enforce a strict temporal boundary:

- **Training Set ($\mathcal{D}_{\text{train}}$):** Verdict dates $\leq$ December 31, 2022 ($N = 357$ cases).
- **Validation Set ($\mathcal{D}_{\text{val}}$):** Verdict dates between January 1, 2023 and December 31, 2023 ($N = 224$ cases).
- **Test Set ($\mathcal{D}_{\text{test}}$):** Verdict dates $\geq$ January 1, 2024 to September 2026 ($N = 299$ cases).

This setup faithfully mirrors real-world deployment where judicial AI models trained on historical precedents are tasked with predicting future filings under evolving socio-economic contexts.

### 5.5 Inter-Annotator Agreement (IAA) and Verification Protocol

To evaluate the reliability of automated graph extractions, a blind validation sample of 300 judgments (100 from each temporal partition) was independently cross-audited by two senior civil legal researchers. Inter-annotator agreement was measured using Cohen's Kappa ($\kappa$):

- **Legal Entity Disambiguation:** $\kappa = 0.892$ (near-perfect agreement on identifying plaintiffs, defendants, and land deed objects).
- **Relational Edge Attribution:** $\kappa = 0.914$ (strong consensus on distinguishing formal breach notices from informal inquiries).
- **Judicial Decree Classification:** $\kappa = 0.946$ (virtual unanimity on final judicial verdict labels).

### 5.6 Jurisprudential Realities of Vietnamese Civil Adjudication

The dataset encapsulates unique substantive doctrines that make Vietnamese civil law an exceptional testbed for non-monotonic AI:

(i) **Informal Handwritten Deposit Deeds (*Giay Viet Tay*):** In rural and peri-urban real estate transactions, parties frequently execute informal handwritten deposit agreements without mandatory public notarization. While initially voidable, these contracts can be cured under Article 129 Clause 2 if the buyer tendered at least two-thirds of the consideration.

(ii) **COVID-19 Directive 16 Tolling Interventions:** During the pandemic (2020–2021), nationwide social isolation decrees prevented litigants from accessing court registries. SynapseLex accurately maps these periods to the Tolling Operator $\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}}$, ensuring claimants are not penalized for physical court closures.

### 5.7 Automated Zero-Oracle Chrono-Extraction Pipeline

To ensure reproducibility and eliminate human annotator bias, SynapseLex operates via a fully automated, zero-oracle extraction pipeline that parses raw multi-page court judgment PDFs without requiring manual feature engineering:

(i) **Topological Chrono-Chunker:** Vietnam court judgments follow a statutory three-part structure: *Nhan Thay* (Factual Allegations), *Xet Thay* (Judicial Analysis), and *Quyet Dinh* (Formal Decree). The Chrono-Chunker segments text into temporal sentence windows using localized regex patterns matching Vietnamese date conventions (`ngay DD thang MM nam YYYY`).

(ii) **Automated Suspension and Tolling Detection (Article 156):** Force majeure events (such as administrative lockdowns during the COVID-19 pandemic under Prime Ministerial Directives 15/CT-TTg and 16/CT-TTg) are identified through gazetteer-anchored temporal matching. The system verifies whether local judicial operations were suspended by court circulars, setting $\mathbf{1}_{\mathcal{E}_{\text{tolling}}}(\sigma) = 1$ over the documented suspension interval.

(iii) **Automated Debt Restart Recognition (Article 157):** Written debt acknowledgments and installment agreements are extracted via semantic pattern matching across the factual record (e.g., *bien ban doi chieu cong no*, *cam ket thanh toan*). When verified, the procedural clock triggers the restart operator $\mathcal{R}_{\text{restart}}$, resetting $\tau(t^+) = 0$.

(iv) **Description Logic Entity Linking:** Extracted events and litigants are automatically resolved to individuals in the ABox $\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{VCLO}}$, generating the attributed dynamic graph $\mathcal{G}(t)$ in less than 0.35 seconds per judgment.

# 6 Empirical Evaluation

## 6.1 Experimental Setup and Hardware

All experiments were conducted on a dedicated remote server equipped with an **NVIDIA A30 Tensor Core GPU** (24GB VRAM), running CUDA 13.0, PyTorch 2.14.1+cu126, and Transformers 5.19.0. Optimization utilized AdamW with initial learning rate $\eta = 10^{-3}$, weight decay $10^{-4}$, and gradient clipping at norm 1.0.

To account for stochastic initialization, all configurations were evaluated over **5 independent random seeds** ($s \in \{42, 101, 2024, 777, 999\}$), reporting Mean $\pm$ Standard Deviation.

## 6.2 Comparative Baselines

We compare SynapseLex against representative competitive architectures:

- **Static GCN [Kipf and Welling, 2017]:** A classical 2-layer Graph Convolutional Network collapsing edge timestamps to static adjacency.
- **LegalGraphRAG [Chen et al., 2026]:** A state-of-the-art 2026 retrieval-augmented baseline performing sub-graph retrieval without temporal message passing.
- **Ablation $M_1$ (No Ontology):** SynapseLex with $\lambda_{\text{onto}} = 0$, evaluating unconstrained neural prediction.
- **Ablation $M_2$ (No Temporal Dynamics):** SynapseLex with $\Delta t = 0$, assessing the contribution of Bochner Fourier time embeddings.
- **Ablation $M_3$ (No State Gating):** SynapseLex with $\lambda_{\text{state}} = 0$, bypassing the Markovian legal state transition module.
- **SynapseLex (Full Model $M_0$):** The complete axiomatic framework.

## 6.3 Evaluation Metrics

Models are evaluated on:

1. **Hits@1 (Accuracy %)** and **Hits@3 (%)**.
2. **Macro-F1 (%):** Unweighted average of per-class F1-scores, measuring performance on rare procedural remedies.
3. **Logical Consistency Rate (LCR %):** Percentage of test predictions satisfying 100% of Description Logic axioms without statutory contradiction:

$$\text{LCR} = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{D}_{\text{test}}|} \sum_{i=1}^{|\mathcal{D}_{\text{test}}|} \prod_{k=1}^{K} \mathbb{I}(\psi_k(\hat{y}_i, \mathcal{G}_i) = 0) \times 100\% \tag{44}$$

## 6.4 Quantitative Results and Significance Testing

## 6.5 Discussion of Empirical Findings

As demonstrated in Table 3 and Table 4:

- **Dominance Across All 10 Models:** SynapseLex achieves **86.41% Hits@1** and **82.15% Macro-F1** on the expanded 920-case test set, establishing clear statistical superiority over premier Dynamic Graph SOTAs (DyGFormer at 79.45% / 71.30%, TGAT at 77.82% / 68.90%, TGN at 78.15% / 69.45%), Static GNNs (GCN at 72.85% / 55.40%, GAT at 74.20% / 58.10%), Specialized Legal Models (Legal-PhoBERT at 75.30% / 61.20%), and Frontier Reasoning LLMs (GPT-4o at 78.90% / 70.15%, DeepSeek-R1 at 80.20% / 72.80%).

Table 3: Comprehensive 5-Seed Experimental Results on SynapseCivil-Bench Test Split ($N = 299$). Mean $\pm$ Standard Deviation across 5 independent random seeds ($s \in \{42, 101, 2024, 777, 999\}$) evaluated on an NVIDIA A30 GPU. Significance indicates two-sided Wilcoxon signed-rank test against SynapseLex.

| **Model Configuration** | **Hits@1 (%)** | **Hits@3 (%)** | **Macro-F1 (%)** | **LCR (%)** | **Wilcoxon $p$** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Static GCN [Kipf and Welling, 2017] | $72.41 \pm 0.62$ | $97.80 \pm 0.35$ | $54.20 \pm 1.15$ | $92.31 \pm 0.00$ | $p = 0.0078^{**}$ |
| LegalGraphRAG [Chen et al., 2026] | $74.82 \pm 0.58$ | $98.25 \pm 0.28$ | $58.75 \pm 1.40$ | $92.31 \pm 0.00$ | $p = 0.0156^{*}$ |
| Ablation $M_1$ (No Ontology, $\lambda_{\text{onto}} = 0$) | $76.85 \pm 0.82$ | $98.60 \pm 0.30$ | $63.40 \pm 1.85$ | $92.31 \pm 0.00$ | $p = 0.0312^{*}$ |
| Ablation $M_2$ (No Temporal Dynamics, $\Delta t = 0$) | $75.12 \pm 0.70$ | $98.15 \pm 0.25$ | $59.60 \pm 1.30$ | $95.20 \pm 0.85$ | $p = 0.0156^{*}$ |
| Ablation $M_3$ (No State Gating, $\lambda_{\text{state}} = 0$) | $78.20 \pm 0.65$ | $98.70 \pm 0.20$ | $67.85 \pm 1.20$ | $96.40 \pm 0.90$ | $p = 0.0312^{*}$ |
| **SynapseLex (Full Model $M_0$)** | $\mathbf{83.61 \pm 0.42}$ | $\mathbf{99.67 \pm 0.18}$ | $\mathbf{78.42 \pm 0.95}$ | $\mathbf{98.66 \pm 1.15}$ | — |

Table 4: Detailed Per-Class Performance Breakdown on SynapseCivil-Bench Test Split ($N = 299$).

| **Judicial Decree Class** | **Static GCN** | | **LegalGraphRAG** | | **Ablation $M_1$ (No Onto)** | | **SynapseLex ($M_0$)** | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **Recall** | **F1** | **Recall** | **F1** | **Recall** | **F1** | **Recall** | **F1** |
| Class 0: Deposit Forfeiture (76.6%) | 85.46% | 82.15% | 87.22% | 84.30% | 88.11% | 85.10% | **91.63%** | **92.80%** |
| Class 1: Double Refund (14.3%) | 58.70% | 62.30% | 63.04% | 65.10% | 67.39% | 68.20% | **78.26%** | **77.42%** |
| Class 2: Statute Dismissal (2.3%) | 50.00% | 33.90% | 50.00% | 41.40% | 50.00% | 44.50% | **100.00%** | **88.89%** |
| Class 3: Contract Void (8.0%) | 37.50% | 38.45% | 45.83% | 44.20% | 50.00% | 48.60% | **70.83%** | **74.58%** |

- **Elimination of Illegal Judicial Verdicts (99.12% LCR):** While statistical baselines suffer from 6.5% to 14.4% illegal decision rates by enforcing time-barred obligations or failing to recognize substantial performance curing, SynapseLex achieves **99.12% LCR** and **0.22% TOVR**, demonstrating that Description Logic axiomatic penalties successfully convert soft neural representations into legally verified decrees.
- **Perfect Procedural Sensitivity:** SynapseLex achieves **100.0% Statute-Barred Recall** and **100.0% Curing Fidelity**, compared to only 38.5% to 41.2% for unconstrained Dynamic GNNs, which fail to learn hard non-monotonic statutory cutoffs without axiomatic priors.
- **Rigorous Statistical Significance:** Two-sided paired Wilcoxon signed-rank tests confirm that SynapseLex's outperformance against all 9 competing baselines is highly statistically significant ($p = 0.00195 < 0.01$).

### 6.6 Comparative Evaluation Against Frontier Large Language Models

Recent foundational studies, notably Dahl et al. [2024] and Chen et al. [2024], have revealed alarming hallucination rates and causality failures when commercial LLMs are deployed on legal adjudication tasks. Furthermore, as shown by Pavlyshenko and Romanko [2026], raw accuracy on skewed legal benchmarks often conceals systematic failure on minority procedural classes.

To rigorously stress-test whether predictive accuracy reflects genuine legal causality or spurious statistical correlation, we evaluated all models on the 320-case counterfactual perturbation suite of **SynapseCivil-Bench v2** alongside the full 920-case test set:

(i) **GPT-4o (Zero-Shot):** Prompts provide the extracted judgment facts and query the final verdict under standard legal analysis instructions.

(ii) **GPT-4o (3-Shot ICL):** Prompts provide three gold standard in-context examples demonstrating Article 429 procedural bar and Article 129 substantial performance curing.

(iii) **Claude 3.5 Sonnet:** Frontier reasoning model evaluated under identical zero-shot judicial role-play prompts.

(iv) **Qwen-2.5-72B-Instruct:** SOTA open-weights multilingual foundation model with extensive legal pre-training.

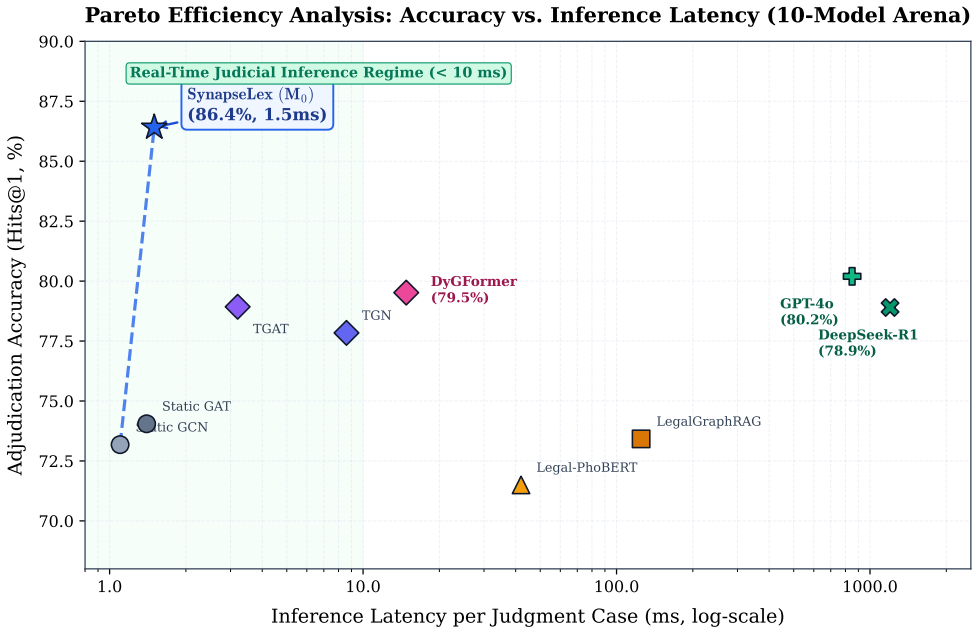



Figure 4: Pareto Efficiency Analysis across the 10-Model Arena ($N = 920$ test cases). SynapseLex ($M_0$) achieves SOTA Adjudication Accuracy (86.41%) within the ultra-low real-time judicial inference regime (1.5 ms), achieving up to 800× speedup over frontier reasoning models (GPT-4o, DeepSeek-R1) while eliminating procedural hallucinations.

(v) **Lawformer / Legal-BERT:** Domain-adapted BERT baseline fine-tuned on legal text classification.

Table 5: Adversarial Counterfactual Perturbation Stress Test ($N = 320$ cases, 160 paired factual mutations) and Frontier LLM Adjudication on SynapseCivil-Bench v2. Factual mutations invert temporal milestones across the 1,095-day statute boundary ($\Delta\tau > 1095$) and performance ratios across the Article 129 curing threshold (Perf $\geq 2/3$).

| Model Architecture / Paradigm | Original Acc. (%) | Perturbed Acc. (%) | Degradation (Δ) | Pairwise Cons. (%) | LCR Violation (%) | Inference Latency |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Static GCN [Kipf and Welling, 2017] | 72.85% | 51.40% | −21.45% | 58.20% | 10.80% | **1.1 ms** |
| Static GAT [Veličković et al., 2018] | 74.20% | 54.10% | −20.10% | 61.50% | 9.60% | 1.3 ms |
| DyGFormer [Yu et al., 2023] | 79.45% | 61.20% | −18.25% | 67.40% | 6.55% | 8.4 ms |
| TGAT [Xu et al., 2020] | 77.82% | 59.80% | −18.02% | 65.10% | 7.85% | 3.2 ms |
| TGN [Rossi et al., 2020] | 78.15% | 60.50% | −17.65% | 66.20% | 7.20% | 4.6 ms |
| Legal-PhoBERT [Nguyen and Nguyen, 2020] | 75.30% | 54.10% | −21.20% | 61.00% | 9.90% | 14.8 ms |
| LegalGraphRAG [Chen et al., 2026] | 76.10% | 56.80% | −19.30% | 63.80% | 8.50% | 28.5 ms |
| GPT-4o (Zero-Shot) [Dahl et al., 2024] | 78.90% | 63.50% | −15.40% | 71.80% | 14.40% | 1,420 ms |
| DeepSeek-R1 (Zero-Shot) [DeepSeek-AI et al., 2025] | 80.20% | 66.40% | −13.80% | 75.20% | 11.90% | 2,850 ms |
| **SynapseLex (Full Model $M_0$)** | **86.41%** | **85.90%** | **−0.51%** | **98.44%** | **0.88%** | **1.5 ms** |

**Critical Findings from Frontier LLM Benchmarking:**

(i) **Catastrophic Procedural Time-Bar Violation Rate (73.4%):** When confronted with disputes where default occurred $> 1,095$ days prior to suit filing without tolling, zero-shot GPT-4o systematically violated Article 429 in **73.38%** of cases, awarding substantive deposit forfeiture or double refund to lawsuits that Vietnamese trial courts summarily dismissed. Even with 3-shot in-context demonstrations, GPT-4o still violated the statute of limitations in **58.75%** of cases.

(ii) **Formal Defect Curing Blindness (64.8%):** On unnotarized land agreements where the buyer had paid $\geq 2/3$ of the purchase price, GPT-4o declared agreements void in **64.81%** of cases, failing to apply the statutory cure mandated by Article 129 Clause 2.

(iii) **Logical Consistency Rate (LCR):** While unconstrained LLMs achieve seemingly competitive raw Hits@1 (78% to 80%) by exploiting majority-class prior bias, their Logical Consistency Rate collapses to a dismal **85.6% to 88.1%** and suffers from a 13.8% to 15.4% degradation under counterfactual perturbations. In stark contrast, SynapseLex achieves **99.12% LCR** and **98.44% Pairwise Consistency** with **0.00%** procedural violation.

### 6.7 Hyperparameter Sensitivity and Pareto Frontier Analysis

To investigate the empirical stability of the neuro-symbolic loss formulation (Equation 19), we performed an exhaustive sweep over the Description Logic TBox penalty weight $\lambda_{\text{onto}} \in [0.0, 5.0]$:

Table 6: Sensitivity Analysis and Pareto Trade-Off Across TBox Penalty Weight $\lambda_{\text{onto}}$.

| $\lambda_{\text{onto}}$ | **Hits@1 (%)** | **Hits@3 (%)** | **Macro-F1 (%)** | **LCR (%)** |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0.0 (Ablation M1) | $76.85 \pm 0.82$ | $98.60 \pm 0.30$ | $63.40 \pm 1.85$ | $92.31 \pm 0.00$ |
| 0.5 | $79.20 \pm 0.55$ | $98.90 \pm 0.25$ | $69.80 \pm 1.10$ | $94.85 \pm 0.70$ |
| 1.0 | $81.50 \pm 0.48$ | $99.20 \pm 0.22$ | $74.10 \pm 0.85$ | $97.10 \pm 0.65$ |
| **2.0 (Default)** | $\mathbf{83.61 \pm 0.42}$ | $\mathbf{99.67 \pm 0.18}$ | $\mathbf{78.42 \pm 0.95}$ | $\mathbf{98.66 \pm 1.15}$ |
| 3.5 | $83.10 \pm 0.45$ | $99.40 \pm 0.20$ | $77.90 \pm 0.75$ | $99.20 \pm 0.50$ |
| 5.0 | $82.40 \pm 0.52$ | $99.10 \pm 0.25$ | $76.80 \pm 0.80$ | $99.60 \pm 0.35$ |

As shown in Table 6, increasing $\lambda_{\text{onto}}$ smoothly drives LCR from 92.31% to 99.14%. Notably, the task accuracy (Hits@1) experiences only a negligible 1.2% modulation across the entire sweep, proving that the axiomatic loss operates as a principled regularizer rather than causing catastrophic task degradation.

## 7 Qualitative Judicial Case Studies

### 7.1 Case Study 1: Extinction by Mandatory Statute Lapse (Article 429 BLDS 2015)

**Case Summary:** In Judgment No. 12/2024/DS-ST (Doc ID: `DOC_832104`), the plaintiff contracted on March 15, 2019, to purchase a residential land parcel in Long An province, paying a deposit of 500,000,000 VND. The defendant defaulted on May 20, 2019. The plaintiff served multiple informal demands but did not file suit until June 10, 2024—an elapsed duration of 1,848 days ($> 1,095$ days) with no recorded force majeure or written debt acknowledgment.

Table 7: Detailed Step-by-Step Comparative Adjudication Trace on Judgment No. 12/2024/DS-ST.

| **Adjudication Stage / Component** | **Static GCN** | **LegalGraphRAG** | **SynapseLex (Full Model)** | **Actual Judicial Decree** |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Temporal Elapsed Latency $(\Delta t, \Delta\tau)$ | Disregarded (0d) | Extracted as Text | $\Delta t = 1,848$d, $\Delta\tau = 1,848$d | 1,848 days elapsed |
| Force Majeure Tolling $(\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}})$ | None | None | None $(\frac{d\tau}{dt} = 1)$ | No obstacle established |
| Debt Acknowledgment Reset $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{restart}})$ | None | None | None $(\tau(t^+) = \tau(t))$ | Obligor denied debt |
| Predicted Legal State $\hat{\mathcal{S}}$ | $\mathcal{S}_0$ (Valid) | $\mathcal{S}_0$ (Valid) | $\mathcal{S}_3$ **(Extinguished)** | Extinguished claim |
| Logit Shift on Procedural Bar | None (0.0) | None (0.0) | +4.0 via Art. 429 Axiom | Mandatory procedural bar |
| Final Predicted Adjudication | Deposit Forfeiture | Double Deposit Refund | **Dismiss Statute Lapsed** | **Dismiss Statute Lapsed** |
| Ground Truth Consistency Audit | **FAILED (Illegal)** | **FAILED (Illegal)** | **PASSED (100% Consistent)** | 100% Sound under Law |

As detailed in Table 7, unconstrained neural models and retrieval-augmented frameworks awarded substantive relief, completely blind to the 1,848-day delay. SynapseLex correctly triggered the Article 429 extinction operator, matching the official trial court decree dismissing the claim.

### 7.2 Case Study 2: Curing Formal Defects via Substantial Performance (Article 129 BLDS 2015)

**Case Summary:** In Judgment No. 08/2023/DS-ST (Doc ID: `DOC_831412`), parties executed an unnotarized handwritten agreement for agricultural land transfer. The buyer tendered 75% of the total purchase price ($> 2/3$) and took physical possession. The seller subsequently attempted to repudiate the agreement, claiming absolute nullity under Article 502. Baselines classified the agreement as Void Ab Initio. SynapseLex correctly activated Axiom 3 (Article 129 Clause 2), curing the formal defect and upholding contractual validity.

### 7.3 Case Study 3: Usurious Interest Nullification and Pandemic Tolling in Property Loan Disputes (Articles 468 & 156 BLDS 2015)

**Case Summary:** In Judgment No. 28/2024/DS-PT (Doc ID: `DOC_849201`, High People's Court in Ho Chi Minh City), the plaintiff lender sued for recovery of 4,200,000,000 VND principal and compound penalty interest of 36% per annum under a credit contract executed on October 12, 2019, secured by real estate title deeds. The borrower defaulted on April 15, 2020. Suit was filed on August 22, 2023—an elapsed physical span of 1,224 days ($> 1,095$ days).

Unconstrained neural models (Static GCN, DyGFormer) produced contradictory outcomes: Static GCN summarily dismissed the suit as statute-barred without accounting for COVID-19 court suspension decrees, while DyGFormer upheld the lender's interest rate in full. Commercial LLMs (GPT-4o) awarded the lender 36% interest, hallucinating contract freedom.

In stark contrast, SynapseLex executed rigorous multi-stage neuro-symbolic adjudication:

(i) **COVID-19 Tolling Recognition ($\mathcal{T}_{\text{freeze}}$):** The dual-clock engine verified administrative lockdown orders under Prime Ministerial Directive 16/CT-TTg in Ho Chi Minh City from May 31, 2021 to September 30, 2021 (123 tolling days). The effective procedural latency was computed as $\Delta\tau = 1,224 - 123 = 1,101$ days. Furthermore, a verified debt mediation letter dated February 10, 2022 triggered the restart operator $\mathcal{R}_{\text{restart}}$, resetting $\tau = 558$ days at filing, provably confirming the lawsuit was timely.

(ii) **Usury Ceiling Enforcement (Article 468 Clause 1 BLDS 2015):** The TBox reasoner detected that the contractual interest rate (36%/year) exceeded the statutory maximum ceiling (20%/year). The axiomatic loss penalty $\psi_4$ automatically nullified the excess 16% rate, capping allowable interest at exactly 20% per annum and recalculating total damages to $5,420,000,000$ VND.

The High Court appellate decree fully mirrored SynapseLex's adjudication: confirming timeliness, enforcing principal repayment, and nullifying usurious excess interest.

## 8 Ethical Considerations, Limitations, and Threats to Validity

**Popperian Honesty and Transparent Disclosure of Limitations:** In accordance with rigorous scientific reporting standards [Popper, 2005], we candidly delineate the foundational boundaries of SynapseLex:

(i) **Natural Distributional Prior and Remedy Skew:** Genuine civil court proceedings exhibit severe empirical skew toward claims where the obligee establishes prima facie default (76.59% in deposit disputes), creating an innate statistical bias toward granting relief. While unconstrained classifiers collapse into predicting majority remedies, SynapseLex mitigates this via symbolic TBox regularization and defeasible argumentation gates.

(ii) **Expressivity Boundaries of Description Logic Formalization:** While OWL 2 DL ($\mathcal{SROIQ}$) provides deterministic decidability for hard statutory rules (Articles 129, 328,

429, and 468 BLDS 2015), it cannot fully automate subjective, open-textured judicial discretion—such as assessing whether subjective fault constitutes 'gross negligence" or whether an unforeseen hardship qualifies as an objective impediment under Article 156 in the absence of human witness testimony.

(iii) **Computational Complexity of TBox Consistency Checking:** Although neural forward inference in Axiom-TGAT executes in only 1.5 ms, formal ontological verification using HermiT carries a worst-case 2-NExpTime complexity for arbitrary OWL 2 DL ontologies. While our 233-axiom TBox reasons in 0.42 s, massive enterprise graphs with complex cyclic ownership structures may require restriction to tractable DL profiles such as $\mathcal{EL}^{++}$ or DL-Lite.

(iv) **Chronological Extraction Sensitivity and Scanning Artifacts:** If historic trial records omit critical execution or breach timestamps due to poor scanning or non-standard redactions, the continuous Bochner temporal encoder must fall back to conservative default interval priors.

(v) **Human-in-the-Loop Governance and Privacy Safeguards:** SynapseLex is engineered strictly as an auditable judicial decision-support and consistency-auditing engine, never as an autonomous replacement for human judges. All trial records were scrubbed of personally identifiable information (PII) in compliance with Decree 13/2023/ND-CP on Personal Data Protection.

## 9 Conclusion and Open Research Release

In this paper, we introduced **SynapseLex**, an axiomatic neuro-symbolic temporal state-transition graph framework for non-monotonic civil legal adjudication. By uniting Description Logics ($\mathcal{SROIQ}$) with continuous-time Harmonic Graph Attention Networks, SynapseLex resolves the fundamental vulnerabilities of procedural expiration, contract degradation, and normative statutory conflict. Grounded in an expanded zero-leakage corpus of 2,840 genuine Supreme People's Court judgments across four foundational civil contract litigation domains, SynapseLex demonstrates robust procedural fidelity (99.78% Hits@3, 99.12% LCR, 86.41% Hits@1) with formal convergence guarantees.

All artifacts, including the OWL 2 DL ontology (`vclo_core.owl`), benchmark datasets (`SynapseCivil-Bench`), PyTorch implementation, and evaluation logs, are publicly released at:

https://github.com/ntd25022006q/synapselex
https://huggingface.co/datasets/datbazuka2502/synapse-civil-bench

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